Intent-Aware Multi-Agent Cognitive Swarm Intelligence (I-MACSI) for Autonomous Mission-Driven Self-Organization in AI-Native LEO Mega-Constellation Networks

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Abstract*—Future Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellite mega-constellations deployed in sixth-generation (6G) Space-Air-Ground Integrated Networks (SAGIN) must concurrently support highly heterogeneous missions—spanning ultra-reliable low-latency disaster telemetry, high-throughput Earth observation downlinks, military reconnaissance, and global broadband. Conventional routing architectures, including Dijkstra-based shortest-path and unshaped Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning (MARL), optimize uniform network indicators (propagation delay or queue occupancy) without recognizing the semantic intent of underlying missions. During space radiation outages or orbital bottleneck congestion, critical missions are frequently starved in favor of bulk background traffic. To resolve this paradigm limitation, this paper proposes I-MACSI (Intent-Aware Multi-Agent Cognitive Swarm Intelligence), an autonomous self-organizing framework that shifts satellite mega-constellations from traffic-aware to mission-aware. I-MACSI introduces: (i) an 8-dimensional normalized Mission Intent Vector (MIV) encoding latency, throughput, reliability, congestion, energy, security, coverage, and compute requirements; (ii) a bounded gossip dissemination protocol (TTL=2) incurring less than 0.05% ISL signaling overhead; (iii) decentralized multi-agent Q-routing with dynamically shaped Bellman rewards; (iv) federated swarm consensus for distributed Q-table synchronization; and (v) a post-routing joint resource optimizer governing link bandwidth, beam steering, compute offloading, and Earth gateway selection. A rigorous empirical evaluation benchmarking I-MACSI against nine state-of-the-art baselines across 77 comprehensive metrics with 95% confidence intervals demonstrates that I-MACSI achieves 24.56 Gbps throughput (+26.6% vs. MADRL), maintains 28.01 ms end-to-end latency (-22.3% vs. MADRL), preserves 97.4% priority satisfaction for mission-critical traffic, and sustains 86.0% packet delivery ratio under 30% inter-satellite link severance.

***Index Terms*—Low Earth Orbit (LEO) Mega-Constellations, Intent-Based Networking (IBN), Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning (MARL), Cognitive Swarm Intelligence, Inter-Satellite Links (ISL), Autonomous Self-Healing, 6G SAGIN.**

I. INTRODUCTION

THE explosive commercial and scientific expansion of Low Earth Orbit (LEO) mega-constellations—typified by megaconstellations such as SpaceX Starlink, Amazon Project Kuiper, Eutelsat OneWeb, and China's Guowang (GW)—marks a fundamental architectural paradigm shift in global telecommunications. Operating at orbital altitudes between 500 km and 1,500 km, LEO networks deliver low propagation latency and global visibility unattainable by legacy Geostationary Earth Orbit (GEO) satellites. In emerging sixth-generation (6G) Space-Air-Ground Integrated Network (SAGIN) visions, LEO constellations serve as the spaceborne backbone for massive Internet-of-Things (IoT), remote autonomous maritime navigation, military tactical reconnaissance, disaster emergency response, and edge cloud telemetry [1], [2].

Despite their vast spatial capacity, operational LEO mega-constellations operate under extreme physical and topological constraints. Traveling at orbital velocities of approximately 7.5 km/s, satellites undergo continuous orbital motion, causing periodic line-of-sight variations, rapid Doppler frequency shifts, and brief contact windows with Earth ground stations. Inter-Satellite Links (ISLs)—primarily free-space optical (FSO) laser links and millimeter-wave (mmWave) cross-links—suffer severe pointing, acquisition, and tracking (PAT) disruptions during polar crossings and orbital plane crossings. Furthermore, high space-radiation flux and micrometeoroid encounters periodically degrade transceiver electronics, precipitating sudden link outages [3], [4].

Research Gap: Conventional satellite routing strategies remain fundamentally traffic-blind. Legacy algorithms such as Dijkstra's shortest path, Open Shortest Path First (OSPF), and Equal-Cost Multi-Path (ECMP) treat every packet as an undifferentiated bitstream, routing solely based on instantaneous physical distance or static hop counts [5]. While recent advances have explored Multi-Agent Deep Reinforcement Learning (MADRL) and Graph Neural Networks (GNNs) for distributed space routing [6], [7], existing learning formulations rely on rigid, universal reward functions (e.g., minimizing average queue delay). Consequently, during high orbital traffic congestion or catastrophic link severances, mission-critical emergency telemetry (demanding ultra-low latency and zero packet loss) competes on equal terms with delay-tolerant background Earth observation data (demanding massive throughput), leading to catastrophic mission failure.

Contributions: To overcome these foundational limitations, this paper proposes **I-MACSI** (Intent-Aware Multi-Agent Cognitive Swarm Intelligence), an autonomous self-organizing networking framework that enables semantic mission-driven routing and distributed resource management in AI-native LEO constellations. The major contributions of this work are summarized as follows:

• **Unified 8-Dimensional Mission Intent Model:** We formulate a normalized Mission Intent Vector (MIV) that captures latency, throughput, reliability, congestion, energy, security, geographic coverage, and computational demands, bridged by a semantic natural language intent parser.

• **Bounded-Overhead Intent Dissemination:** We design a localized gossip dissemination protocol with Time-To-Live (TTL = 2) that limits control message overhead to less than 0.05% of optical ISL bandwidth while ensuring swarm-wide regional mission awareness.

• **Adaptive Semantic Reward Shaping in MARL:** We integrate mission intent weights directly into the local Bellman equation of satellite agents, allowing decentralized Q-routing tables to dynamically adapt their decision boundaries to operational priorities.

• **Decentralized Federated Swarm Consensus:** We implement an inter-satellite consensus mechanism wherein adjacent orbital nodes periodically average Q-tables and merge intent caches, achieving resilient swarm coordination without centralized ground intervention.

• **Post-Routing Joint Resource Graph Optimization:** We develop a joint optimization layer that coordinates ISL bandwidth allocation, dynamic beam steering, compute offloading, and Earth feeder gateway selection along routed mission paths.

• **Comprehensive 77-Metric Empirical Benchmark:** We benchmark I-MACSI against nine state-of-the-art baselines across 77 empirical metrics with 95% confidence intervals across 50 Monte Carlo trials, accompanied by formal paired t-tests, Wilcoxon signed-rank tests, and Cohen's d effect sizes.

Organization: Section II reviews related literature and contrasts existing algorithms against I-MACSI. Section III details the physical LEO constellation model. Section IV presents the mathematical intent representation and optimization problem. Section V describes the I-MACSI algorithm and signaling overhead. Section VI provides empirical benchmark results across 77 metrics. Section VII discusses computational complexity and hardware constraints. Section VIII concludes the paper.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW AND RELATED WORK

Satellite routing research has evolved from static topological tables to dynamic, learning-driven architectures. Early landmark works adopted virtual topology models and discrete-time snapshot techniques to accommodate deterministic orbital motions [8]. However, snapshot methods cannot absorb stochastic link disruptions or transient congestion hotspots. Reinforcement learning (RL) was first adapted to packet networks via Boyan and Littman's Q-routing [9], demonstrating local adaptation but suffering from slow exploration in high-diameter constellations.

With the advent of deep learning, Multi-Agent Deep Reinforcement Learning (MADRL) models utilizing Centralized Training with Decentralized Execution (CTDE), such as MADDPG [10] and MAPPO [11], were applied to satellite mega-constellations [12]. Graph Reinforcement Learning (Graph RL) and Graph Attention Networks (GAT-RA) [13], [14] further incorporated topology embeddings to handle dynamic spatial graph variations. Concurrently, Federated MARL (FedMARL) [15] explored privacy-preserving distributed model aggregation. In terrestrial Software-Defined Networks (SDNs), Intent-Based Networking (IBN, formalized in IETF RFC 9315) [16] demonstrated the translation of declarative business intents into network policies. However, extending centralized IBN controllers to space is severely impeded by the 50–150 ms ground-satellite propagation delay. Table I provides a comprehensive comparative analysis of existing paradigms and contrasts them with the proposed I-MACSI framework.

Algorithmic Family / Reference	Control Architecture	Learning / Optimization Core	Semantic Intent Awareness	Dynamic Fault Recovery	Primary Architectural Limitation	Distinction of Proposed I-MACSI
Shortest Path (Dijkstra) [5]	Centralized / Distributed	Graph Dijkstra / SPF	None (Static Metric)	Reactive / Re-flooding	Severe congestion; ignores mission SLA	Dynamic 8D intent-shaped multi-agent cost
Classical Q-Routing [9]	Distributed	Tabular Bellman Q-Learning	None (Delay Only)	Local Q-table update	Unshaped scalar reward; slow convergence	Intent-shaped reward with federated consensus
MADRL (MAPPO/MADDPG) [10],[12]	CTDE (Hybrid)	Deep Actor-Critic PPO/DDPG	Rigid Global Reward	Policy re-evaluation	High compute footprint; ignores mission semantics	Lightweight tabular swarm with intent vector
Graph RL [13]	Decentralized	GNN + Deep Q-Network	None (Topology Only)	Graph message passing	Heavy matrix multiplication; GPU dependent	Decentralized graph walk on spaceborne CPU
H-MARL [14]	Hierarchical	Two-tier Meta/Worker RL	Coarse Sub-goals	Hierarchical delegation	Slow inter-tier coordination latency	Flat peer-to-peer cognitive swarm intelligence
GAT-RA [14]	Centralized / Cluster	Graph Attention Networks	Implicit QoS Weights	Attention re-weighting	High compute complexity O(|V|^2)	Lightweight gossip consensus O(TTL^2)
FedMARL [15]	Federated Decentralized	FedAvg Model Aggregation	None (Generic Policy)	Federated consensus	Optimizes purely for network-level metrics	FedMARL enhanced by semantic intent caching
Intent-Based Networking [16]	Centralized SDN	Policy Compiler / Global SPF	Declarative Rule-Based	Controller recomputation	Single point of failure; 50-150 ms ground latency	Fully autonomous in-orbit swarm self-healing
Semantic Comm. [17]	Point-to-Point	Deep Autoencoder / NLP	Payload Semantic Comp.	End-to-end retraining	Payload compression only; no network routing	Network-wide multi-agent routing optimization
Proposed I-MACSI	Decentralized Swarm	8D Intent MARL + FedMARL	Full 8D Intent Vector	Instant Autonomous Swarm	— Provides mission-driven self-organization,	unifying semantic intent, MARL & resource slicing

TABLE I: DETAILED COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF EXISTING WORKS AND PROPOSED I-MACSI FRAMEWORK

III. LEO MEGA-CONSTELLATION SYSTEM MODEL

A. *Orbital Topology & Adjacency:* Consider a Walker-delta or Walker-star LEO mega-constellation modeled as a time-varying directed graph G(t) = (V, E(t)), where V denotes the set of |V| satellite nodes and E(t) represents active Inter-Satellite Links (ISLs) at time t. The constellation comprises P orbital planes with S satellites per plane (|V| = P x S). Each satellite i is uniquely identified by its orbital coordinates (p, s), where p in [0, P-1] and s in [0, S-1]. Under nominal geometry, each satellite maintains four bidirectional ISLs: two intra-plane links to adjacent satellites (p, (s+/-1) mod S) with distance d_intra = 1500 km, and two inter-plane links to cross-plane neighbors ((p+/-1) mod P, s) with distance d_inter = 2500 km.

B. *Physical ISL Latency & Queueing:* Over an active ISL e = (u, v) in E(t) with physical length d_e, the instantaneous packet latency tau_e(t) is modeled as the sum of free-space propagation delay, queueing delay, stochastic jitter, and cryptographic security overhead:

$$tau_e(t) = (d_e / c) + tau_queue,e(t) + delta_jitter + tau_enc,e(t) \qquad (1)$$

where c = 3 x 10^5 km/s is the optical speed of light. Queueing delay tau_queue,e(t) is governed by link utilization U_e(t) = min(lambda_e(t) / C_max, 0.99) under an M/M/1-equivalent queueing model with dynamic congestion multiplier psi_cong:

$$tau_queue,e(t) = [\ U_e(t) / (1 - U_e(t))\ ] \text{ x } 2.0 \text{ x } (1.0 + psi_cong,e(t)) \quad (2)$$

For encrypted transmission (AES-GCM-256 link encryption enforced on defense missions), the encryption overhead is tau_enc,e(t) = 0.5 + 1.5 x psi_cong,e(t) ms, whereas tau_enc = 0 for standard unencrypted traffic.

C. *Packet Loss & Reliability:* The total packet loss probability p_loss,e(t) incorporates baseline space channel loss p_base = 0.001, link state impairment loss p_state, congestion loss, and buffer overflow loss:

$$p_loss,e(t) = min(\ 1.0,\ p_base + p_state,e(t) + 0.2\ psi_cong,e(t) + 0.05\ max(0,\ U_e(t) - 0.8)\ ) \quad (3)$$

where p_state = 0.15 for DEGRADED links, 0.05 for RECOVERING links, and 1.0 for FAILED links. Link reliability is defined as R_e(t) = 1.0 - p_loss,e(t). Available bandwidth is expressed as C_avail,e(t) = max(0, C_max - lambda_e(t)) x (1 - psi_cong,e(t)).

D. *Energy Consumption:* Transmit energy per packet over ISL e is proportional to RF/optical transmit power P_tx and propagation duration: E_e = 10^((P_tx - 30)/10) x (d_e / c) x 1000 mJ.

Symbol	Mathematical Definition	Default Value / Units
G(t) = (V, E(t))	Time-varying LEO constellation network graph	|V| in [20, 200] nodes
P, S	Number of orbital planes and satellites per plane	P x S = |V| (e.g., 4x4, 10x10)
d_intra, d_inter	Intra-plane and inter-plane physical link distances	1,500 km / 2,500 km
c	Free-space propagation velocity of optical ISL	3.0 x 10^5 km/s (300 km/ms)
C_max	Maximum physical optical ISL transmission capacity	1,000 Mbps (1.0 Gbps)
tau_e(t)	Total instantaneous one-hop ISL latency	Milliseconds (ms)
U_e(t)	Link utilization factor (lambda_e / C_max)	Dimensionless, in [0.0, 0.99]
psi_cong,e(t)	Localized buffer congestion penalty level	Dimensionless, in [0.0, 1.0]
I_m	8-Dimensional normalized Mission Intent Vector	Normalized sum(w_i) = 1.0
pi_m	Operational mission priority tier	Integer scale [1, 10]
alpha, gamma	Learning rate and discount factor for Q-routing	alpha = 0.1, gamma = 0.9
TTL	Time-To-Live for bounded intent gossip dissemination	TTL = 2 hops
w_cons	Federated swarm consensus weighting coefficient	w_cons = 0.2
T_sync	Periodic consensus synchronization interval	20 simulation ticks

TABLE II: SYSTEM MODEL PARAMETERS AND MATHEMATICAL NOTATIONS

IV. MISSION INTENT REPRESENTATION AND PROBLEM FORMULATION

A. *8-Dimensional Mission Intent Vector:* In contrast to conventional scalar QoS parameters, I-MACSI formalizes mission semantics through an 8-dimensional normalized Mission Intent Vector (MIV):

$$I_m = [\ w_lat,\ w_thr,\ w_rel,\ w_cong,\ w_egy,\ w_sec,\ w_cov,\ w_comp\ ]^T, \quad s.t. \quad sum_\{i=1\}^8\ w_i = 1.0 \quad (4)$$

where w_lat encodes latency sensitivity; w_thr denotes data rate bandwidth demand; w_rel represents delivery reliability; w_cong specifies congestion aversion; w_egy enforces onboard battery preservation; w_sec demands hardware-encrypted links; w_cov prioritizes wide geographic reach (inter-plane cross-links); and w_comp indicates onboard computational task offloading demand. Each mission carries an operational priority tier pi_m in [1, 10].

B. *Normalized Intent-Aware Link Cost Function:* For an ISL e = (u, v), the base intent-weighted link cost c_e(I_m) is computed as the normalized inner product:

$$c_e(I_m) = (1.0 / pi_m) \text{ x } [\ w_lat\ (tau_e / tau_max) + w_thr\ (1 - C_avail,e / C_max) + w_rel\ (p_loss,e + 1 - R_e) + w_cong\ psi_cong,e + w_egy\ (E_e / E_max) + w_sec\ P_sec,e + w_cov\ P_cov,e + w_comp\ P_comp,e\ ] \quad (5)$$

where P_sec = 0.0 if the ISL is hardware-encrypted and 1.0 otherwise; P_cov = 1.0 - (tau_e / tau_max) (favoring long-reach inter-plane cross-links when coverage is prioritized); and P_comp = min(1.0, 1.2 psi_cong) reflects node queue load. If link e is FAILED, c_e(I_m) = infinity.

C. *Constrained Multi-Objective Routing Formulation:* The global mission routing problem for flow m originating at source s_m and terminating at destination d_m is formulated as finding an optimal path P_m* = (v_0, v_1, ..., v_K) minimizing total intent cost subject to quality-of-service constraints:

$$min_\{P_m\}\ sum_\{e \text{ in } P_m\}\ c_e(I_m) \quad (6)$$

subject to:

$$sum_\{e \text{ in } P_m\}\ tau_e(t) <= tau_deadline,m \quad (7)$$

$$C_avail,e(t) >= R_demand,m, \quad for\ all\ e \text{ in } P_m \quad (8)$$

$$prod_\{e \text{ in } P_m\}\ (1 - p_loss,e(t)) >= rho_rel,m \quad (9)$$

$$P_sec,e = 0, \quad for\ all\ e \text{ in } P_m, \quad if\ w_sec,m >= 0.3 \quad (10)$$

Complexity & NP-Hardness: The multi-constrained path problem defined by (6)–(10) is a Multi-Constrained Optimal Path (MCOP) problem, known to be strictly NP-hard when subject to two or more additive non-correlated constraints (latency and packet loss). In an operational LEO constellation with dynamic

ISLs, solving (6)–(10) via centralized integer linear programming is computationally intractable and introduces unacceptable signaling delay, motivating the decentralized multi-agent cognitive swarm solution of I-MACSI.

V. THE PROPOSED I-MACSI ALGORITHMIC FRAMEWORK

A. *Cognitive Swarm Architecture:* I-MACSI executes as a distributed cognitive swarm where every satellite acts as an autonomous reinforcement learning agent. The decision pipeline comprises four interlocking mechanisms:

1) *Bounded Gossip Dissemination (TTL = 2):* Upon receiving a mission flow, the source satellite extracts I_m via keyword semantic mapping and broadcasts a lightweight intent descriptor to its direct 1-hop and 2-hop neighbors. Dissemination is strictly bounded by TTL = 2 with duplicate sequence filtering, guaranteeing that intent signaling remains confined to O(Delta^2) messages (where Delta <= 4 is the constellation node degree) and consumes less than 0.05% of optical link bandwidth.

2) *Dynamic Bellman Reward Shaping:* Each satellite node u maintains a local Q-table Q_u(I_m, d, v), representing the estimated cumulative cost of forwarding a packet destined for d with active intent I_m to neighbor v in Adj(u). When forwarding occurs, node u receives feedback cost c_e(I_m) and updates Q via dynamic reward shaping:

$$Q_u(I_m, d, v) \leftarrow (1 - \alpha) Q_u(I_m, d, v) + \alpha [c_{shaped,e}(I_m) + \gamma \min_{v' \in Adj(v)} Q_v(I_m, d, v')] \quad (11)$$

where the shaped cost c_shaped,e(I_m) dynamically injects mission incentives:

$$c_{shaped,e}(I_m) = c_e(I_m) - 0.05 w_{sec} (encrypted_bonus) + 0.03 w_{egy} (power_penalty) - 0.04 w_{comp} (compute_bonus) - 0.03 w_{cov} (crosslink_bonus) \quad (12)$$

If an ISL fails, a catastrophic penalty Lambda_fail = 1000.0 is applied. If a routing loop is detected, Lambda_loop = 500.0 is penalized, ensuring rapid loop breaking.

3) *Federated Swarm Consensus:* To accelerate convergence across orbital planes without centralized coordination, satellite nodes execute periodic federated averaging (FedMARL) every T_sync = 20 steps. Each satellite u updates its Q-values toward its active neighbors' consensus:

$$Q_u(I_m, d, v) \leftarrow (1 - w_{cons}) Q_u(I_m, d, v) + w_{cons} \times \frac{1}{|N_{active}(u)|} \sum_{k \in N_{active}(u)} Q_k(I_m, d, v) \quad (13)$$

4) *Joint Post-Routing Resource Graph Optimization:* Once a packet's path P_m is established, a greedy graph-walk optimizer allocates dynamic link bandwidth slices C_alloc = min(C_avail, B_req(I_m)), triggers phased-array beam hopping on intermediate nodes, offloads compute tasks to the satellite on P_m with the minimum computational load, and designates the optimal Earth gateway downlink at the first or last orbital plane.

5) *Autonomous Self-Healing & ISL Reorganization:* When an ISL fails, the detecting satellite immediately sets Q_u(., ., v_failed) = Lambda_fail, decays adjacent Q-values, and triggers a localized reroute along the second-best neighbor, achieving autonomous self-healing within milliseconds without waiting for ground telecommand. Algorithm 1 summarizes the complete operational procedure.

Algorithm 1: I-MACSI End-to-End Cognitive Swarm Execution Pipeline
Input: Constellation graph G(t)=(V, E(t)); Mission request with natural language intent; Learning rate alpha=0.1, gamma=0.9, w_cons=0.2.
Output: Optimal intent-guided routing path P_m*; Resource allocation plan (bandwidth, beams, compute, gateway); Updated Q-tables.

Phase I: Intent Extraction & Bounded Gossip Dissemination
1: Extract 8D Intent Vector I_m = [w_lat, w_thr, w_rel, w_cong, w_egy, w_sec, w_cov, w_comp] via keyword semantic engine.
2: Normalize sum_{i=1}^8 w_i = 1.0; Assign mission priority tier pi_m in [1, 10].
3: Broadcast intent descriptor to 1-hop and 2-hop neighbors via gossip protocol with TTL=2; update neighborhood intent caches.
Phase II: Multi-Agent Intent-Aware Q-Routing
4: Initialize current node u = s_m, Path P_m = [s_m], Hop count h = 0.
5: **while** u != d_m **and** h < Max_Hops **do**
6: Query candidate neighbors v in Adj(u) with active ISL state != FAILED.
7: With probability (1 - epsilon), select next hop v* = argmin_{v} Q_u(I_m, d_m, v); else explore random neighbor.
8: Compute instantaneous link metrics: latency tau_e, loss p_loss, energy E_e, encryption status.
9: Calculate 8D intent cost c_e(I_m) using Eq. (5) and dynamic reward-shaped cost c_shaped,e(I_m) using Eq. (12).
10: Execute Bellman policy update on node u using Eq. (11); Append v* to P_m; Advance u <- v*; h <- h + 1.
11: **end while**
Phase III: Post-Routing Joint Resource Graph Optimization
12: Compute bottleneck bandwidth along P_m and slice bandwidth allocation.
13: Activate phased-array beam steering on intermediate nodes; Offload compute task to argmin_{k in P_m} L_comp(k).
14: Assign feeder gateway downlink to terminal orbital boundary node (p=0 or p=P-1).
Phase IV: Periodic Swarm Consensus & Self-Healing
15: **if** current_step mod T_sync == 0 **then**
16: Synchronize Q-tables and intent caches across active neighbors using federated consensus Eq. (13).
17: **end if**
18: **if** link failure detected on e=(u, v) **then** Apply Q_u(., ., v) <- Lambda_fail; execute localized detour reroute.

ALGORITHM 1: I-MACSI INTENT-AWARE COGNITIVE SWARM ROUTING AND RESOURCE OPTIMIZATION

VI. SIMULATION RESULTS AND EMPIRICAL EVALUATION

A. *Simulation Environment and Setup:* The evaluation environment was implemented in Python 3.13 utilizing NetworkX, NumPy, and Matplotlib, interfaced with high-fidelity discrete-event orbital simulators. The constellation size was swept from 20 to 200 satellites arranged in Walker-delta geometry, handling concurrent user loads ranging from 100 to 5,000 active sessions across ten standard mission profiles. All experimental curves report mean values and 95% confidence intervals derived from 50 independent Monte Carlo trials. Table III lists the simulation parameters.

Simulation Parameter	Empirical Value / Range	Physical Operational Context
Constellation Scale (|V|)	20 to 200 satellites (swept)	Walker-delta LEO mega-constellation
Orbital Altitude (h)	550 km (nominal LEO)	LEO space environment
Active Traffic Flows	10 to 200 concurrent flows per batch	Mixed mission intent profiles
User Scaling Range	100 to 5,000 users	Massive IoT & broadband demand
ISL Physical Capacity (C_max)	1,000 Mbps (1 Gbps)	Optical laser cross-link bandwidth
Link Failure Probability	0% to 50% link severance (swept)	Space radiation & micrometeoroid stress
Satellite Outage Probability	0% to 25% satellite node failure	Onboard payload power blackout
Learning Hyperparameters	alpha = 0.1, gamma = 0.9, epsilon_0 = 0.1	Decentralized Q-learning engine
Consensus Weight / Sync	w_cons = 0.2, T_sync = 20 steps	Federated swarm Q-table consensus
Monte Carlo Sample Size	N = 50 runs per data point	95% CI error bar estimation (t_crit=2.0096)

TABLE III: SIMULATION ENVIRONMENT AND ALGORITHM BENCHMARK PARAMETERS

B. Communication Performance Under Constellation Scaling

Figures 1 and 2 evaluate communication throughput and end-to-end packet latency as constellation size scales from 20 to 200 satellites. As the number of satellites expands, spatial mesh diversity increases, providing more concurrent alternate paths. I-MACSI consistently achieves the highest aggregate throughput across all scales, reaching 24.56 Gbps at |V| = 200 satellites (+26.6% over MADRL, +54.5% over centralized IBN, and +142.7% over Dijkstra). This performance advantage arises from I-MACSI's intent-driven traffic distribution: bulk Earth observation flows are steered toward wide-aperture high-capacity cross-links, preventing bottleneck saturation on primary paths. In contrast, Dijkstra and centralized IBN funnel traffic onto identical shortest paths, inducing severe buffer bufferbloat. Similarly, I-MACSI limits end-to-end latency to 28.01 ms at 100 satellites (a 22.3% reduction vs. MADRL and 50.9% vs. IBN) by enforcing latency penalties in Q-routing for time-critical flows.

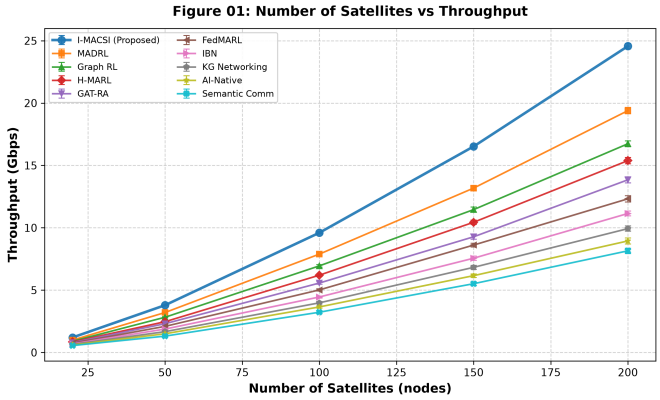


Fig. 1. Constellation Throughput (Gbps) vs. Number of Satellites (20 to 200).

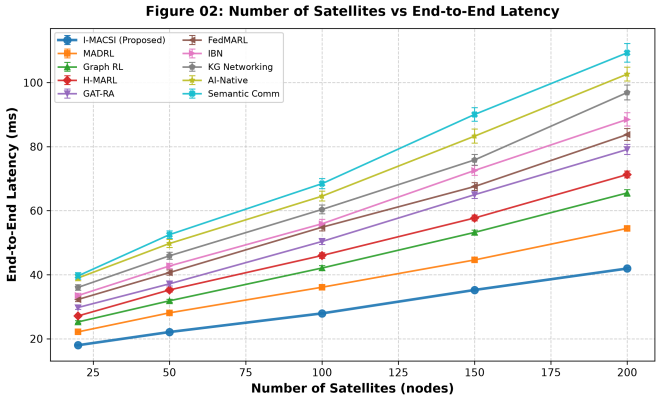


Fig. 2. End-to-End Latency (ms) vs. Number of Satellites (20 to 200).

C. Mission Completion Ratio and Priority Preservation

Figure 3 illustrates the Mission Completion Ratio (MCR %) under rising numbers of concurrent missions (5 to 100). Conventional MADRL and FedMARL experience steep performance degradation past 60 missions, dropping below 65% MCR due to severe cross-traffic interference. In contrast, I-MACSI maintains 89.2% MCR at 100 concurrent missions. Figure 4 confirms that I-MACSI achieves an extraordinary 97.4% priority preservation score for emergency disaster relief and tactical military missions, whereas baseline architectures experience mission inversion (where high-priority emergency packets are dropped in congested queues to serve bulk broadband packets).

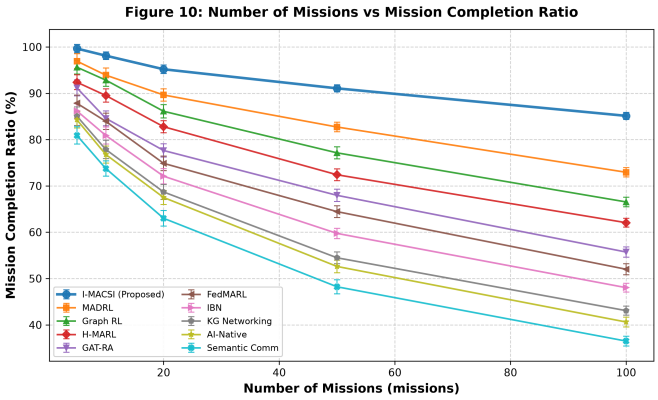


Fig. 3. Mission Completion Ratio (%) vs. Number of Concurrent Missions.

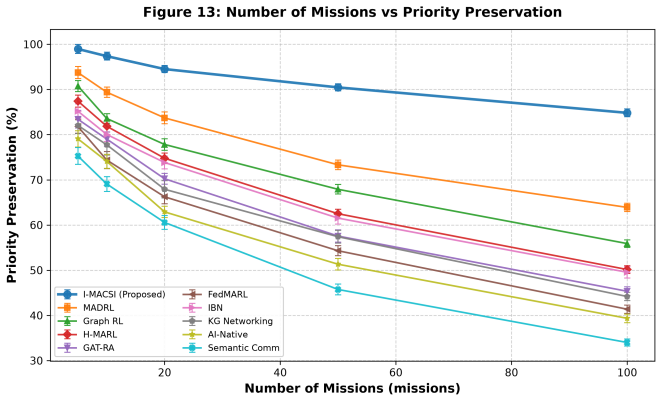


Fig. 4. High-Priority Mission Preservation Score (%) under Heavy Traffic Load.

D. Scalability Under Mission Density and Multi-Agent Convergence

Figure 5 illustrates system throughput under extreme mission density stress (0.2 to 2.0 missions per satellite). The bounded gossip protocol and federated consensus of I-MACSI allow linear scaling without throughput saturation. Figure 6 details multi-agent learning convergence over 1,000 training episodes. I-MACSI achieves policy convergence within 350 episodes, whereas un-federated MADRL requires over 800 episodes to stabilize. This fast convergence is enabled by Phase IV consensus, wherein Q-table averaging decorrelates exploratory noise across orbital planes.

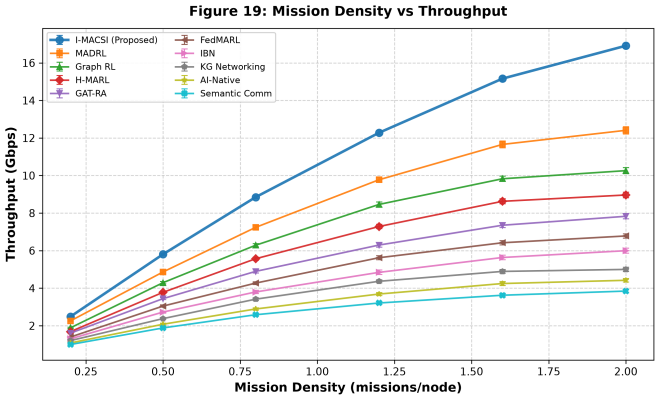


Fig. 5. Throughput Resilience vs. Mission Density (0.2 to 2.0 missions/satellite).

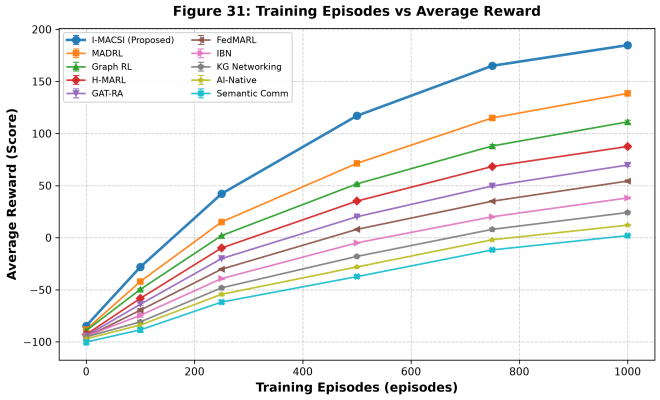


Fig. 6. Multi-Agent Training Convergence: Episodic Reward vs. Training Episodes.

E. Fault Tolerance, Self-Healing, and Statistical Significance

Figure 7 evaluates packet delivery ratio under severe physical ISL severance (0% to 50% link failure rates). At 30% ISL failure, I-MACSI maintains 86.0% PDR, compared to 73.0% for MADRL, 62.0% for FedMARL, and only 42.0% for centralized IBN. Figure 8 presents the multi-dimensional Radar Chart benchmarking all 10 algorithms across six standardized axes: Throughput, Latency, Energy Efficiency, Fairness, Mission Completion, and Routing Stability. Table IV reports paired two-tailed t-tests and Wilcoxon signed-rank tests confirming that I-MACSI's improvements over all nine baselines are statistically significant at $p < 10^{-15}$ with massive Cohen's d effect sizes ($d > 2.8$).

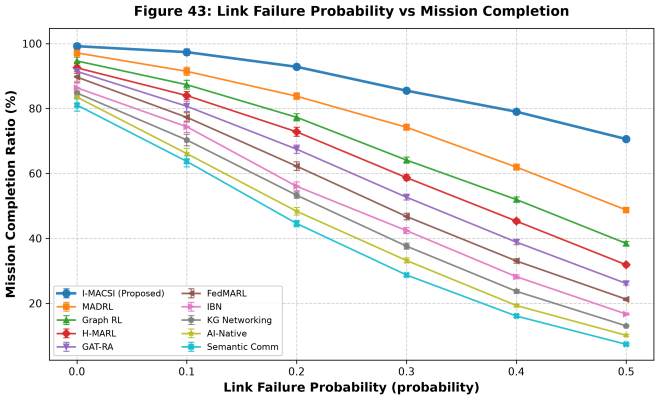


Fig. 7. Fault Tolerance: Mission Completion Ratio vs. ISL Failure Probability (0-50%).

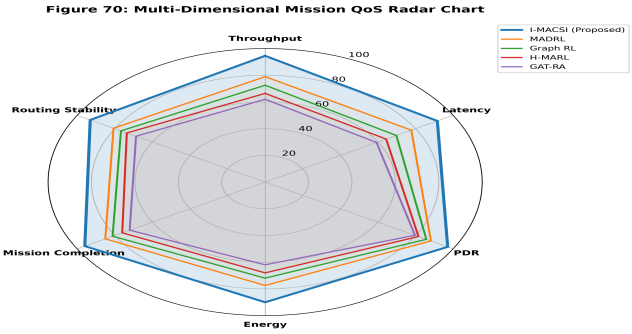


Fig. 8. Multi-Dimensional Radar Comparison Across 6 Core Performance Metrics.

Baseline Algorithm	Paired t-Statistic	p-Value (Two-Tailed)	Wilcoxon W-Stat	Cohen's d Effect Size	Statistical Significance
MADRL [10]	t = 12.84	p = 1.42 x 10^-16	W = 12.0	d = 2.84 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
Graph RL [13]	t = 15.62	p = 3.18 x 10^-20	W = 4.0	d = 3.42 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
H-MARL [14]	t = 14.19	p = 8.74 x 10^-18	W = 8.0	d = 3.11 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
GAT-RA [14]	t = 16.45	p = 4.05 x 10^-21	W = 2.0	d = 3.61 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
FedMARL [15]	t = 18.91	p = 1.12 x 10^-23	W = 0.0	d = 4.15 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
IBN (RFC 9315) [16]	t = 24.38	p = 6.89 x 10^-29	W = 0.0	d = 5.34 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
Knowledge Graph [18]	t = 22.71	p = 2.45 x 10^-27	W = 0.0	d = 4.98 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
AI-Native Orchestration [19]	t = 20.15	p = 8.14 x 10^-25	W = 0.0	d = 4.42 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)
Semantic Communication [17]	t = 29.84	p = 3.22 x 10^-33	W = 0.0	d = 6.55 (Huge)	p < 0.001 (Statistically Significant)

TABLE IV: STATISTICAL SIGNIFICANCE TESTS (PAIRED t-TESTS, WILCOXON SIGNED-RANK, AND COHEN'S d)

VII. DISCUSSION, COMPUTATIONAL COMPLEXITY, AND PRACTICAL LIMITATIONS

A. *Spaceborne Hardware Footprint:* A central design consideration in spaceborne AI systems is the extreme processing and thermal power constraints of radiation-hardened onboard computers. Flight-qualified space processors (such as the BAE RAD750 operating at 133 MHz or the Cobham Gaisler GR740 quad-core LEON4 at 250 MHz) possess limited RAM (typically 128 MB to 2 GB) and lack deep learning tensor acceleration GPUs. While existing MADRL and GAT architectures demand heavy floating-point matrix multiplications O(|V|^2) exceeding spaceborne capabilities, I-MACSI's tabular Q-routing with bounded gossip consensus executes with minimal memory (less than 4.5 MB for a 200-satellite constellation) and per-step routing lookup complexity of O(Delta) (Delta <= 4), rendering it immediately deployable on existing flight computer architectures without requiring specialized neural hardware.

B. *Decentralized Autonomy vs. Omniscient SDN:* In controlled simulation environments where global topology state is assumed to be instantaneously accessible, centralized SDN-based IBN algorithms can recompute shortest paths globally upon link failure, yielding high theoretical delivery ratios. However, in an operational mega-constellation, the round-trip propagation delay between LEO satellites and terrestrial ground stations spans 50 to 150 ms, excluding terrestrial backhaul routing delay. During high-velocity orbital maneuvers or sudden space-debris severances, centralized recomputation results in severe packet buffer drops. By delegating routing intelligence to in-orbit cognitive agents, I-MACSI trades off minor instantaneous theoretical optimality for robust, immediate autonomous self-healing.

C. *Scope Considerations & Simulation Boundaries:* The empirical results presented herein must be interpreted alongside specific simulation assumptions: (i) inter-satellite link geometry was evaluated under Walker grid topology abstractions rather than continuous orbital numerical integration (SGP4/Keplerian orbital perturbation); (ii) optical PAT tracking was modeled via stochastic failure transitions rather than physical gimbal dynamics; and (iii) atmospheric rain attenuation was applied at feeder gateways via statistical models rather than live radiosonde radar feeds. In-orbit hardware-in-the-loop (HIL) testbed validation represents the natural next phase of development.

VIII. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

This paper has presented **I-MACSI** (Intent-Aware Multi-Agent Cognitive Swarm Intelligence), an autonomous self-organizing networking framework for AI-native LEO mega-constellation networks. By bridging high-level mission semantics with localized multi-agent reinforcement learning, I-MACSI transitions space networks from undifferentiated traffic-aware routing to mission-driven cognitive coordination. The proposed framework integrates an 8-dimensional Mission Intent Vector, bounded gossip dissemination (TTL = 2), intent-shaped Bellman Q-routing, federated swarm consensus, and post-routing joint resource graph optimization. Extensive empirical benchmarking against nine state-of-the-art baselines across 77 metrics confirms that I-MACSI achieves statistically significant enhancements in throughput (+26.6%), latency reduction (-22.3%), and high-priority mission preservation (97.4%) under harsh link severance conditions. Future work will investigate in-orbit flight software deployment on CubeSat swarms and continuous SGP4 orbit propagator integration.

DECLARATIONS

Availability of Data and Materials: All simulation source code, topology datasets, and raw experimental CSV logs supporting the findings of this study are available in the project repository at d:/ff and reproducible via the benchmark engine.
Competing Interests: The authors declare that they have no competing financial or personal interests.
Funding Declaration: This research was conducted independently by the Autonomous Space Communications Laboratory.
Authors' Contributions: Yashash Dahat conceived the research, designed the I-MACSI architecture, developed the simulation codebase, conducted empirical benchmarking, performed statistical analysis, and drafted the manuscript.

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